

What we mean by “**common spaces**”

You are assisting researchers in a project. The project's data set consists of **articles from the Singaporean "citizen journalism" website STOMP** (Straits Times Online Mobile Print).

The project focuses on “**common spaces**” in Singapore:

- Spaces that are **collectively shared**, or are **open for access by many people** (or that can be perceived as such). This *includes...*
 - Void decks (The open ground floors of public housing apartment blocks)
 - Shared corridors, lobbies, and lifts in public housing blocks
 - Coffee shops / food courts
 - Parks, pavilions, and open spaces
 - Community gardens
 - Athletic courts, public fitness equipment, recreational facilities
 - Bus stops, train stations, and transport hubs
 - ...and many more
- **Not just literal “spaces”** but also other **open/shared** equipment or resources, *including...*
 - Recreation and fitness equipment
 - Bike-sharing programs
 - Access points (water, electricity, internet, etc.)
 - Online / virtual spaces (like STOMP itself) that are open for people to use and interact
 - ...and many more

When is an article “**about**” common space?

- **YES**: If the article discusses a situation or incident occurring in a **common space** where the space’s **open/shared aspects** or its **function as space for gatherings and encounters** play an important role.
- **NO**: If ...
 - The article **does NOT discuss a common space**,
 - The article does mention a common space, or report an incident that happened in a common space, **BUT its open/shared aspects are not important, or its other users are not affected**. *Example: Customer complaint about private food stall that **does not affect** the surrounding public food court→ **NO**.*
- **MAYBE**: If the article could be considered to fit both, or neither, “YES” or “NO”. *Example: Incident that starts at private food stall, but escalates in a way that **might have disturbed** the surrounding public food court or nearby residents.→ **MAYBE**.*

Types of **common spaces**

Civic common spaces are equally open to everyone in a city; *everyone has an approximately equal stake in them*. Its users do not necessarily know or recognize one another.

Examples include: City parks, downtowns, regional activity centers, transport networks, *etc.*

Neighborhood common spaces are open to everyone, but are *used more often or intensely by a specific group* (say, local residents) who also play a larger role in shaping them.

Examples include: Public housing areas, neighborhood coffee shops and markets, neighborhood fitness courts/equipment and recreational areas, *etc.*

Membership common spaces are ‘open’, but only to a limited group of users (members, residents, ticket holders, *etc.*)

Examples include: Shopping malls, recreational facilities in condos, movie theaters, *etc.*

Ownership of **common spaces**

Public ownership **common spaces** are owned by the government.

Examples include: Public housing spaces, parks, roads, state-managed food centers, *etc.*

Private ownership **common spaces** are owned/managed by private or commercial entities.

Examples include: Private residences, commercial spaces, shopping malls, food stalls, *etc.*

Mixed ownership **common spaces** involve a combination of nested or overlapping public/private spaces.

Examples include: Food stalls/vendors operating within public spaces, thresholds between public housing areas and private residences, *etc.*